Extinction Archive

Umwelt Archive

COLLECTIVE MEMORY FRACTURE · BIODIGITAL MEMORIAL

Biodesign Challenge 2026 · Convergent Life
Digital Art & AI Technology · MDes

SLIDE 02

The fracture

- Extinction removes **species** and **ecological function**
- It also erodes **shared memory**: shifting baselines, hype cycles (**de-extinction as spectacle**)
- We lose **temporal coexistence**: migrations, synchrony, **daily and seasonal rhythms**

> This project is not “resurrection.” It makes **absence and evidence** discussable.

SLIDE 03

Design questions

- How do we translate **extinction–absence** into **perceivable, debatable** experience?
- How can **AI + biological data** support **disciplined public memory**—without faking nature?
- How do we land in **accountability** (conservation tradeoffs), not only immersion?

SLIDE 04

Concept (one line)

Extinction Archive — an interactive memorial where **peer-reviewed traces** become a **constrained Umwelt**: dossiers, **polyphonic rhythms**, and an **ethics console**—with **citations and confidence** on every layer.

SLIDE 05

Three modules

Module	Role
Species Dossier	Time, movement, sensory **proxies** (orbit, inner ear, genomics—carefully cited)
Polyphony Mixer	**Web Audio**: seasons, flock synchrony, migration tempo → consonance / collapse
Ethics Console	Branching cards + **evidence literacy gate** → different **sonic finales**

SLIDE 06

Hero species (locked)

Species	Biological anchors	Metaphor
Woolly mammoth M. primigenius	Tusk isotopes, Arctic photoperiod, comparative genomics	Long cycles, **low-frequency tempo**, seasonal light
Passenger pigeon E. migratorius	Social synchrony, historic megaflocks	**Phase lock** → **silence** as N falls (Modeled)

SLIDE 07

Bio + Digital (both load-bearing)

Biology: paleo-sensory proxies, isotope trajectories, ethology, extinction mechanisms — **traceable sources**

Digital: conditional generative visuals (**B**) + **procedural / shader** base (**A**); **Web Audio**; **WebAR** + desktop fallback

> Remove either layer and the project stops making sense.

SLIDE 08

Honesty UI: three tiers

- `Cited` — direct literature / dataset
- `Modeled` — inference from accepted methods (with limits)
- `Speculative` — creative extension; **never** sold as footage

> Generative scenes carry: **“Inferred—not recovered reality.”**

SLIDE 09

Living contrast (recommended)

Plants + soil moisture / light / temperature → live telemetry

Framed as an **index of present life**, not a replica of extinct habitat.

One **Mixer** parameter driven by the sensor stream — **one biodigital pipe**.

SLIDE 10

Physical + AR

- **3D print** (tusk “growth core”, skull token, or dossier object)
- **Mobile WebAR** + **full desktop Web** — same assets; **recorded fallback** for demos

SLIDE 11

Ethics console

- **Gate (C):** sort statements into Cited / Modeled / Speculative
- **Branches (B):** funding, invasion risk, land / knowledge stewardship — **incompatible choices**
- **Output:** remixed **ending mix** + short **system consequence** (rules-first)

SLIDE 12

BDC alignment

Deliverables: 10 min + Q&A · visuals · **physical prototype** · **1–5 min creative trailer** · slides on Drive

Judging (4×4): Narrative · Concept · Context · Reflection — **Platinum** needs **≥2.75** in **all** four

SLIDE 13

Prize focus

- **Primary: BDC Prize for Biodigital Excellence**
- **Secondary (if depth):** Outstanding **Social Critique**
- **DNA Futures:** optional — mammoth clock / adaptation claims only with line-by-line citations

SLIDE 14

Sprint (4-week core)

Week	Focus
W1	Evidence cards (both species), storyboard, stack lock
W2	**Mammoth** vertical slice: Dossier + one Mixer lane
W3	**Pigeon** + Ethics B/C + WebAR + living data
W4	Label audit, rehearsal, trailer cut, Q&A list

SLIDE 15

Thank you

Extinction Archive / Umwelt Archive

Sensory–temporal hypotheses for vanished lineages

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Q&A